CV & COVER LETTER TARGETING WORKSHEET

Apprentis

WHY TARGETING MATTERS

Sending the same CV or cover letter to every apprenticeship opportunity won't get you noticed. Employers are looking for candidates who've done their homework, those who understand the company's mission, values, and what makes their team unique.

When you tailor your application, you show that you're not just interested in any role, but this one. This worksheet guides you step-by-step through that process, helping you decode job descriptions, reflect on your strengths, and align your experiences with what employers are actually looking for. The result? Applications that feel relevant, thoughtful, and genuinely stand out.

SECTION 1: DECODE THE JOB AD

Use this space to break down a job description and pull out keywords, values, and priorities.

Example: Job Ad Extract (Digital Marketing Apprentice at Google)

"We're looking for a motivated Digital Marketing Apprentice who is passionate about technology, data, and storytelling. You'll work closely with our marketing team to support content planning, campaign analysis, and community engagement. We value innovation, inclusivity, and collaboration, and are looking for someone who is eager to learn, curious, and excited to be part of a diverse team."

From this ad, we can pull out:

Company Name: Google
Role Title: Digital Marketing Apprentice
Three keywords mentioned in the ad:

- Storytelling
- Collaboration
- Analysis

Core values the company highlights (from their website or mission):

- Innovation
- Inclusivity
- Curiosity

Key responsibilities or tasks listed in the ad:

- Support content planning
- Assist with campaign analysis
- Contribute to community engagement

NOW YOU TRY:

Example: Job Ad Extract (Software Development Apprentice at BT)

BT is looking for a passionate and curious Software Development Apprentice to join our fast-paced tech team. In this role, you'll help design, develop and test innovative digital solutions used by thousands of customers. You'll work with experienced developers using agile methods, write clean and efficient code, and participate in team stand-ups and planning sessions. We're looking for someone with a keen interest in programming, strong problem-solving skills, and a willingness to learn and grow. Our values include innovation, collaboration, and continuous improvement.

Company Name: _____
Role Title: _____
Three keywords mentioned in the ad:

1.
2.
3.

Core values the company highlights (from their website or mission):

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-
-
-

Key responsibilities or tasks listed in the ad:

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-
-
-

What does this company care about most?

SECTION 2: CV TARGETING CHECKLIST

Use this checklist to ensure your CV is tailored to the opportunity.

✅ Cover letter and profile includes the company's name and role title

✅ Your listed skills match keywords from the job description

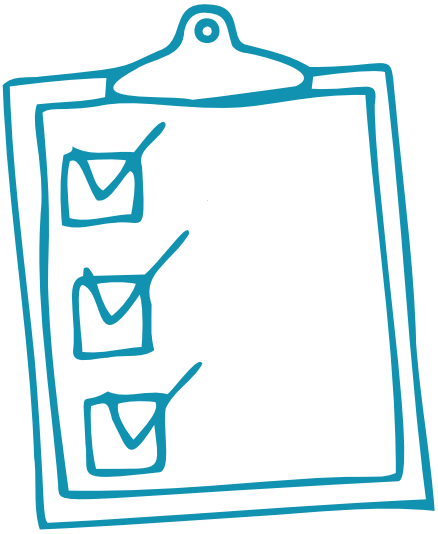
✅ Your past experiences demonstrate skills they're asking for

✅ Any projects or achievements are relevant to the apprenticeship

✅ Soft skills (e.g. teamwork, communication) are clearly shown

✅ Education or qualifications are listed and match role requirements

✅ Layout is clean and easy to read



SECTION 3: COVER LETTER BUILDER

Use the prompts below to guide each paragraph of your cover letter:

Opening: Why Are You Writing?

Start strong. Say what you're applying for and why you're excited.

Example:
"I'm applying for the Software Development Apprenticeship at BT because I'm passionate about coding and want to start a career where I can learn from experienced developers while contributing to real digital projects."

Connection: Why This Company?

Show you've looked into BT and that you share their values.

Example:
"I admire BT's focus on innovation and teamwork. Your commitment to developing digital solutions that help thousands of people is something I'd be proud to be part of. I also value the way you support apprentices to grow through structured learning."

Skills & Stories: Why You're a Good Fit

Use a real story from school or a personal project that shows your interest and potential in tech.

Example:
"During sixth form, I built a simple to-do list web app using HTML, CSS and JavaScript for a coursework project. I taught myself the basics through online tutorials and even fixed a major bug the night before the deadline. The project helped me realise how much I enjoy solving problems and seeing my code come to life."

Value Add: How Can You Help Them?

Show how your mindset and effort can benefit BT's team.

Example:
"I bring enthusiasm, a strong work ethic, and a real interest in software development. I'm comfortable working in teams and I enjoy learning through doing. I'm confident that with guidance, I'll be able to contribute meaningfully to your development projects."

Close: End Strong

Be polite, enthusiastic, and open to next steps.

Example:
"Thank you for considering my application. I'd love the opportunity to grow within BT and contribute to your team. I'm eager to continue learning and develop my skills in a real-world environment."

💡 Remember:

Your CV and cover letter are your introduction, they're not just about your qualifications, but about your potential. When you show that you've done your research and can bring value, you stand out. Targeted is better than generic, every time.

SECTION 4: USING CHATGPT OR AI TOOLS (RESPONSIBLY)

It's okay to use tools to draft ideas—as long as you personalise them.

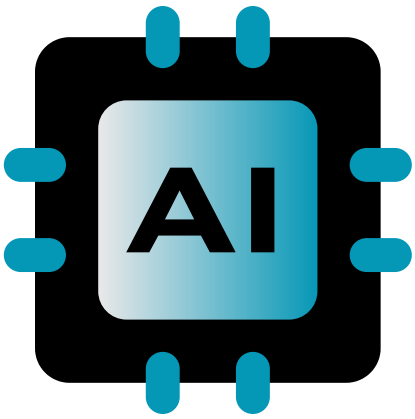
DO:

- Use AI to generate ideas, get structure help, or break writer's block.
- Ask for examples based on your own skills or experience.

DON'T:

- Copy and paste full responses without editing.
- Let AI guess your values, goals, or tone. Those should come from you.

Tip: Paste in your job description and say: "Can you help me tailor a cover letter/CV for this apprenticeship in my voice?" Then tweak the results until it sounds like you.



“People don’t buy what you do; they buy why you do it.”
— Simon Sinek